

Loving-Kindness

Karaniya Metta Sutta

Karaṇīyamatthakusalena, Yaṃ taṃ santaṃ padaṃ abhisamecca; Sakko ujū ca
suhujū ca, Sūvaco c'assa mudu anatimānī,

This is what should be done by one skilled in their own welfare, who wishes to attain the state of peace: Let them be capable, upright, and thoroughly upright, easy to speak to, gentle, and humble.

Santussako ca subharo ca, Appakicco ca sallahukavuttī; Santindriyo ca nipako ca,
Appagabbho kulesu ananugiddho,

Contented, easy to support, with few duties, living lightly; with senses calmed, wise and modest, not greedy or clinging to supporters.

Na ca khuddaṃ samācare kiñci, Yena viññū pare upavadeyyuṃ; Sukhino vā
khemino hontu, Sabbe sattā bhavantu sukhitattā.

Let one not do the slightest mean thing for which wise people would censure them. May all beings be happy and safe, may all beings be happy at heart!

Ye keci pāṇabhūtatti, Tasā vā thāvarā vā anavasesā; Dīghā vā ye mahantā vā,
Majjhimā rassakā aṇukathulā.

Whatever living beings there may be—weak or strong, without exception, long or large, medium, short, subtle or gross;

Diṭṭhā vā yeva adiṭṭhā, Ye ca dūre vasanti avidūre; Bhūtā vā sambhavesī vā, Sabbe
sattā bhavantu sukhitattā.

Those seen and those unseen, those dwelling near and far, those already born and those seeking birth—may all beings be happy at heart!

Na paro paraṃ nikubbetha, Nātimaññetha katthaci naṃ kañci; Byārosanā
paṭighasaññā, Nāññamaññassa dukkhamiccheyya.

Let no one deceive another, or despise anyone anywhere. Let no one through anger or ill-will wish harm upon another.

Mātā yathā niyaṃ puttaṃ, Āyusā ekaputtamanurakkhe; Evam pi sabbabhūtesū;
Mānasaṃ bhāvaye aparimānaṃ.

Just as a mother would protect her only child with her own life, even so, towards all living beings, let one cultivate a boundless heart.

Mettañca sabba lokasmiṃ, Mānasaṃ bhāvaye aparimānaṃ. Uddhaṃ adho ca
tiriyañca, Asambādhaṃ averaṃ asapattaṃ.

And with loving-kindness for the entire world, cultivate a boundless heart: above, below, and all around, unobstructed, free from hatred and enmity.

Tiṭṭhaṃ caraṃ nisinno vā, Sayāno vā yavāt'assa vigatamiddho; Etaṃ satiṃ
adhiṭṭheyya, Brahmametaṃ vihāraṃ idhamāhu.

Whether standing, walking, sitting, or lying down, as long as one is awake, one should sustain this mindfulness. This is called a sublime abiding here.

Diṭṭhiñca anupagamma, Sīlavā dassanena sampanno; Kāmesu vineyya gedhaṃ,
Na hi jātu gabbhaseyyaṃ punareti ti.

Not clinging to fixed views, but virtuous and endowed with clarity of vision, having discarded greed for sensual pleasures, one never again will lie in a womb.

Glossary

Pāli (IAST)	Target transliteration	Target gloss	First-chapter occurrence	Goenka-tradition usage
metta	metta	loving-kindness; goodwill	Karaniya Metta Sutta	The active cultivation of selfless love and goodwill toward all beings, free from expectation or attachment.
sīla	sīla	moral conduct; virtue	Karaniya Metta Sutta	Moral conduct or morality, acting in accordance

Pāli (IAST)	Target transliteration	Target gloss	First-chapter occurrence	Goenka-tradition usage
				with the five precepts, which acts as the foundation of Vipassana.
santa	santa	peace; calm	Karaniya Metta Sutta	The state of peace, Nibbāna, achieved through mental purification.
brahma	brahma	sublime; divine	Karaniya Metta Sutta	Sublime or divine. In compounds like <i>brahmavihāra</i> , it denotes the sublime abidings of metta, karuna, mudita, and upekkha.

Translator Notes

1. **Welfare (*Attha*)**: The opening line refers to *attha-kusala*, meaning "skilled in welfare" or "goodness". In the Goenka tradition, this is interpreted as being skilled in one's own true welfare—which is the path of Dhamma that leads to Nibbāna.
2. **Uprightness (*Uju*)**: The sutta emphasizes being upright (*uju*) and thoroughly upright (*suhujū*). This double emphasis highlights the importance of complete honesty and transparency in one's moral and meditative life.
3. **Boundless Heart (**Mānaṣaṃ (aparimāṇaṃ)*)**: Cultivating a boundless heart toward all beings is the essence of *mettā-bhāvanā*. This is not an emotional or romantic sentiment, but a deep, purified mental state that wishes for the welfare of all without exception.